

Denver Store Staffing Recommendation

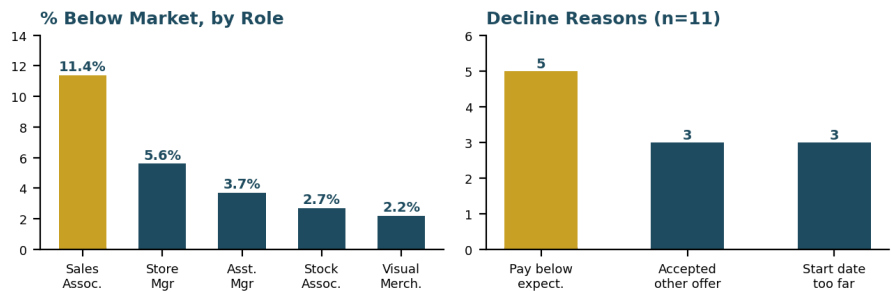
HR Function • Yasmine Lopez • HW3 Data Intelligence Project

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This extends HW1's Quarterly Staffing Forecasting Level 3 opportunity: AI pre-screens applications for basic qualifications before human review. Across all five Denver roles, every offered rate sits below the Denver market rate, but the gap is not even — Sales Associate is furthest behind at 11.4% below market (\$17.50 vs. \$19.75/hr), the largest gap of any role. Store-wide, pay is the single most common reason candidates decline an offer (5 of 11 declines, 45%), ahead of timing (start date too far out, 3 of 11) and competing offers (3 of 11). Of 7 total open seats store-wide, 6 are Sales Associate. Closing the Sales Associate gap costs \$26,208/year across all 8 seats.

KEY FINDINGS

- Every role is offered below Denver market rate — Sales Associate furthest, at 11.4%
- Pay is the #1 decline reason store-wide (5 of 11 declines, 45%)
- 6 of 7 total open seats store-wide are Sales Associate
- Start date too far out ties with competing offers as the #2 decline reason (3 of 11 each)



CHOICE SET & RECOMMENDATION

Option	Annual Cost	Addresses
1. Raise Sales Associate pay to market	\$26,208	Pay decline reason only (5 of 11)
2. Surface Sept 28 start date at application	\$0*	Reduces wasted screening time on timing-mismatched candidates (does not reduce the 3-of-11 decline count)
3. Both (recommended)	\$26,208	Pay decline reason directly (5 of 11) + funnel efficiency on timing-mismatched candidates

**Option 2 does not reduce the timing-decline count — it surfaces the fixed Sept 28 start date at application instead of after screening/interviews, so timing-mismatched candidates self-select out earlier and HR doesn't spend interview time on offers that were always going to be declined. Genuinely reducing timing declines would require changing or staggering start dates, a separate policy decision not supported by the current applicant dataset; this brief therefore does not claim that outcome. Cost figures assume the full 28 hrs/week ceiling stated in the offer letter ("up to 28 hrs/week") — actual scheduled hours are not confirmed in the data, so \$26,208 is an upper-bound estimate, not a confirmed cost.*

Recommendation: Pursue Option 3. Raise Sales Associate pay to \$19.75/hr to match market rate — this directly resolves 5 of the 11 declines store-wide, the single largest lever available, at \$26,208/year across all 8 seats (kept consistent across already-accepted and still-open hires to avoid a pay gap within the same role). Pair it with surfacing the Sept 28 start date at application rather than after interviews, so HR stops investing screening time in candidates who were always going to decline over timing. This does not reduce the 3-of-11 timing declines themselves; reducing those declines would require changing the start-date policy, which is outside the evidence available in this brief. Addressing pay alone still resolves fewer than half of all declines; this combination captures that gain without overstating what the current data can support.

DECISION RIGHTS & GOVERNANCE

The HR Team Lead prepares and owns this recommendation; final pay-rate approval requires sign-off from the Store #13 hiring manager and Finance, given budget impact. Any change to when the Sept 28 start date is surfaced in the application flow is reviewed by HR before candidates are notified — no automated messaging changes go out without a human check.

Tools, Method & Verification

DATA SOURCE

GT_HR_Applicants_Analysis.xlsx — built from GT_HR_Denver_Applicants (148 applicants, 5 roles, provided dataset). All five roles analyzed for this brief.

CLEANING & VALIDATION

The source file arrived as a PDF export with damaged formatting — several rows had columns run together (e.g. "Indeed4 ScreenedN") and a few records wrapped mid-row. Every affected row was rebuilt from the raw text, then independently cross-checked: the reconstructed Days_Applied_To_Start was recomputed from (Proposed_Start_Date – Applied_Date) for all 148 rows. Zero mismatches — every reconstructed value held up against independent date arithmetic.

Two flags carried forward rather than silently resolved: (1) all 148 rows list Store as "Denver-LoHi," which does not match "Cherry Creek North" named in the sourced offer letter — unresolved discrepancy. (2) The offer letter states "up to 28 hrs/week" — a ceiling, not a confirmed scheduled amount — so the \$26,208 annual cost figure is an upper-bound estimate, not a confirmed cost.

ANALYSIS & VERIFICATION

All figures are formula-driven (COUNTIFS, AVERAGEIF) in the linked working sheet — no hand-typed results.

Verification catch: Openings_For_Role and Offered_Rate are both constant per-role lookup values repeated on every applicant row, not per-applicant data. Summing or averaging either field directly (a natural first instinct) would produce a meaningless, multiplied number. Seats open were instead calculated as headcount minus COUNTIFS(Offer_Accepted="Y") by role — the same "read the field before you compute" check applied before any figure was used downstream.

SUPPORTING SHEET

Google Sheets link: [GT_HR_Applicants_Analysis](#)